

Weekly Creator Report — MKBHD

Week of 2026-07-27 · generated 2026-08-05 · engine: template

SAMPLE FIXTURE · illustrative, not real metrics

SYNTHETIC · modelled estimate

Public view / like / comment counts are **real**. Impressions, CTR, retention, traffic, demographics and A/B tests are **synthetic modelled estimates** — this report never uses the creator's private analytics.

MKBHD: public views -43.9% week-over-week, 6 winning test(s) this window.

This week MKBHD's published videos drew 3,173,167 real public views, -43.9% versus the prior week. Modelled CTR moved +23.8% and modelled average view duration +2.5%. All impressions, CTR, retention and A/B figures are synthetic estimates, not the creator's private analytics.

What we tested

SYNTHETIC · modelled estimate

- Thumbnail test on “Fastest Charging Phone Ever Tested!”: variant 'face + reaction' vs current (modelled CTR 8.22% → 9.62%, lift +17.0%).
- Thumbnail test on “Reviewing the Internet's Favorite Gadget.”: variant 'product hero' vs current (modelled CTR 6.54% → 6.36%, lift -2.8%).
- Thumbnail test on “The Wildest Concept Tech at CES 2026!”: variant 'product hero' vs current (modelled CTR 7.42% → 7.77%, lift +4.7%).
- Title test on “What Happened to VR?”: variant 'number/list framing' vs current (modelled CTR 6.75% → 7.47%, lift +10.7%).
- Thumbnail test on “My Entire Studio Setup Tour 2026!”: variant 'bold text overlay' vs current (modelled CTR 6.66% → 8.04%, lift +20.7%).
- Packaging test on “My Entire Studio Setup Tour 2026!”: variant 'cold-open hook' vs current (modelled CTR 6.35% → 5.49%, lift -13.5%).

■ What worked

SYNTHETIC · modelled estimate

- 'clean minimal' thumbnail won on “Why Everyone's Talking About This Camera.” (+21.7% CTR lift — significant and above the 5% effect floor).
- 'bold text overlay' thumbnail won on “My Entire Studio Setup Tour 2026!” (+20.7% CTR lift — significant and above the 5% effect floor).
- 'face + reaction' thumbnail won on “Fastest Charging Phone Ever Tested!” (+17.0% CTR lift — significant and above the 5% effect floor).
- 'chapter restructure' packaging won on “This Tech Was a Huge Letdown.” (+11.4% CTR lift — significant and above the 5% effect floor).
- 'number/list framing' title won on “What Happened to VR?” (+10.7% CTR lift — significant and above the 5% effect floor).
- 'short intro cut' packaging won on “Samsung Galaxy S26 Ultra Review: Peak And...” (+5.9% CTR lift — significant and above the 5% effect floor).

■ What to do next

- Roll winning packaging patterns into upcoming uploads and re-test to confirm.
- Tighten the section between 10% and 15% of video length, where retention falls most steeply (−3.7 points).
- Rerun the inconclusive and small-effect tests with more impressions before calling them.

■ Flagged trends

- Real Public Views is falling (moderate) over the last 8 weeks.
- Impressions is falling (strong) over the last 8 weeks.
- Ctr Pct is rising (moderate) over the last 8 weeks.
- Avg View Duration Sec is falling (mild) over the last 8 weeks.
- Avg View Pct is falling (mild) over the last 8 weeks.

■ Anomalies

- impressions spike on 2026-06-08 ($z=2.31$), synthetic
- ctr pct dip on 2026-06-08 ($z=-2.25$), synthetic

- avg view duration sec spike on 2026-06-08 (z=2.28), synthetic
- avg view pct spike on 2026-06-08 (z=2.02), synthetic

Top videos this window

REAL public data

Title	Views	Published
Samsung Galaxy S26 Ultra Review: Peak Android!	3,962,780	2026-07-21
My Entire Studio Setup Tour 2026!	3,709,338	2026-06-13
Google Pixel 10 Review: Software Wins Again?	3,413,418	2026-07-11
The Most Requested Review of the Year!	3,061,200	2026-06-19
Laptop Buyer's Guide 2026!	2,719,613	2026-06-28

Title themes vs performance

REAL public data

Lightweight TF-IDF k-means over REAL public titles/views. Set VOYAGE_API_KEY to use semantic embeddings instead.

Theme terms	Videos	Avg views	Example
review, most, requested, year	4	3,166,130	Samsung Galaxy S26 Ultra Review: Peak Android!
2026, smartphones, happened, about	15	1,632,827	My Entire Studio Setup Tour 2026!
phone, different, nothing, charging	4	1,186,841	Nothing Phone 3 Review: Still Different!
usb, chaos, explaining, year	1	704,954	Explaining the USB-C Chaos (Again).

Automated QA of the numbers

Verdict: PASS — 1 claims checked. Local deterministic QA (LLM QA unavailable).

CreatorPulse · automated weekly creator pipeline. Synthetic layer calibrated to publicly-plausible ranges (see DECISIONS.md). Public data source: sample-fixture. · Built by Vijay — MKBHD is my favorite YouTuber, so he's the default channel. □